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AI



Trump is set to unveil his
AI roadmap: Here's what
to know

Update 10 a.m. PT: Trump's AI Action Plan was unveiled after this article published. Read TechCrunch's coverage on the [fully released plan here](#).

U.S. President Donald Trump is expected to unveil his long-awaited AI Action Plan at a Washington, D.C. event Wednesday hosted by Silicon Valley insiders — his first major address concerning artificial intelligence since he took office for the second time in January.

The AI Action Plan should provide a roadmap of the Trump administration's strategies, priorities, and concerns around AI — likely a technology that will come to define the 47th president's term.

The plan is effectively a replacement for [the Biden AI executive order](#), the previous administration's AI strategy which placed a large focus on mandating AI companies to submit safety and security reports, and trying to limit racial or otherwise discriminatory bias in frontier AI models. Trump [repealed Biden's order within days of his inauguration](#), arguing that its requirements could be onerous for AI companies, and may hinder American innovation.

In its first six months, the Trump administration has broadly encouraged efforts to accelerate the development and distribution of American AI technology. Trump helped OpenAI, Oracle, and SoftBank [announce their multibillion-dollar](#)

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[Stargate data center project](#), and the president [peeled back restrictions on Nvidia](#) selling its AI chips around the globe.

At the same time, Trump’s AI czar David Sacks has [picked a fight with technology companies over “woke” AI](#), claiming that OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google are supposedly instilling left-leaning values into their AI chatbots and censoring conservative viewpoints.

Some are already pushing back on Trump’s AI Action plan for allegedly putting corporate interests ahead of the public. On Tuesday, a group of more than 90 organizations, including labor, environmental justice, and consumer protection nonprofits, [published an open letter called the People’s AI Action Plan](#). This puts forth a series of AI policies that claim to put the interests of American citizens first, and counter what Trump is expected to announce.

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“We can’t let Big Tech and Big Oil lobbyists write the rules for AI and our economy at the expense of our freedom and equality, workers and families’ well-being,” the group said in a statement to TechCrunch that acknowledged the energy needs of Silicon Valley’s AI data centers.

Trump’s AI Action Plan should advance his administration’s agenda more explicitly, but exactly how remains unclear. Trump is expected to share more details about the plan at [the “Winning the AI Race” summit](#), an event hosted by The Hill and Valley Forum and the All In podcast, which Sacks co-hosts when he’s not serving as a government official or venture capitalist.

Here’s what we know about the AI Action Plan so far.

Accelerating American AI

Trump’s AI strategy is expected to focus on three pillars — infrastructure, innovation, and global influence — according to a report from [Time Magazine](#).

For infrastructure, the Trump administration is reportedly planning to overhaul permitting rules to speed up the development of AI data centers. This aims to help AI companies meet with the growing energy needs to train and serve their AI models. However, it’s widely expected that the rise of AI data centers — [which suck up immense amounts of energy and water from neighboring communities](#) — could [cause energy shortages by the end of the decade](#) unless there’s a rapid increase in energy production.

The president’s infrastructure pillar is also expected to include a plan to modernize America’s

electrical grid and add new sources of energy to power these data centers, according to Time.

On the innovation front, Trump reportedly plans to use his AI Action Plan to [revive the conversation around blocking state AI laws](#) (even though a federal proposition on the issue [overwhelmingly failed last month](#)). This is part of an effort to reduce barriers to innovation for American AI companies, but may ultimately block lawmakers from passing meaningful safety and security standards for AI companies.

As for the global influence pillar, Trump is expected to put forth a strategy to advance the adoption of American AI models and chips, not just in the U.S., but around the world. Federal officials were [spooked by the rise of DeepSeek](#), and other Chinese AI labs such as Qwen and Moonshot AI have since become worthy competitors to OpenAI. Trump wants America's technology to be the global standard.

To advance its goals, the Trump administration is also expected to sign a series of AI-related executive orders on Wednesday, according to [The Washington Post](#). Some of these orders clear the path for faster data center buildouts, while others encourage the export of American technologies.

Combating “woke” AI

One of the executive orders Trump is slated to sign Wednesday would crack down on “woke” AI models, [The Wall Street Journal](#) reported earlier this week. The order requires AI companies with federal contracts — which includes OpenAI, xAI, Google, and Anthropic — to ensure their AI models have neutral and unbiased language.

The crackdown on “woke” AI marks the Republican party’s latest attack on Silicon Valley’s historically left-leaning crowd. In past years, Republicans investigated social media companies for allegedly altering their algorithms to censor conservative voices. Meta’s Mark Zuckerberg recently capitulated to these allegations, and overhauled [Facebook and Instagram’s content moderation](#) to represent more voices.

A key question looming around this executive order is who defines whether AI models are neutral or biased, and how they determine it. Trump has long stated he’s an advocate of free speech, so an executive order setting rules around what an AI model can and can’t say may seem counterintuitive. That said, a Florida judge recently ruled that AI chatbots [are not protected by the First Amendment](#).

In light of this crackdown, OpenAI and other AI labs have tried to [make their AI chatbots represent more viewpoints](#). These companies are in the awkward position to generate AI responses that please everyone, while also not spreading extremist viewpoints or misinformation.

Elon Musk, once Trump’s greatest financial backer whose relationship with the president has recently soured, explicitly started xAI to develop an “anti-woke” AI chatbot, Grok, and combat ChatGPT. However, xAI’s effort to create such a chatbot hasn’t gone so well. In recent weeks, xAI was forced to apologize repeatedly when its [AI chatbot went on antisemitic rants](#) and [consulted Musk’s personal opinions](#) on hot-button issues.

What Silicon Valley and Big Tech want

The White House announced in April it had [received more than 10,000 public comments](#) from companies, local governments, and nonprofit organizations regarding Trump's AI Action Plan.

OpenAI, Google, Meta, and Amazon effectively took the opportunity to submit wishlists of friendly AI policies they'd like to see the Trump administration implement.

Many of America's leading AI model developers asked Trump to use his AI Action plan to guarantee that training large language models on copyrighted material would be fair use, and should therefore be allowed.

Such a protection could benefit these companies significantly, as many of them are involved in active lawsuits with copyright owners from the music, film, news, and book industries. These publishers have accused AI companies of illegally training on their copyrighted works to make AI models, potentially devaluing their media in the process.

Meanwhile, Meta asked Trump to protect open AI models — which are freely available to download online. By releasing its Llama models openly, [Meta has been able to undercut OpenAI and Google's closed offerings](#). However, Anthropic has raised concerns over whether open AI models could leak powerful technology to bad actors, including China.

Other interest groups, including nonprofits such as The Future of Life Institute, used the commenting period to ask the Trump administration to increase investment into AI research efforts outside of commercial entities. The request comes at a time when the Trump administration and [DOGE have slashed funding for American universities](#), many of which have been powerhouses for scientific breakthroughs in recent decades.

It seems unlikely that Trump’s AI Action Plan will feature the same safety and security reporting standards that the Biden administration sought to impose. However, polls show that [most Americans want AI companies to be held to safety standards](#).

Several state lawmakers are [pushing bills that would create safety and security reporting mandates](#), but they may face opposition from the Trump administration and Republican lawmakers should they contradict Trump’s AI Action Plan.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI policy](#) [Government & Policy](#) [Trump](#)

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OpenAI tries to ‘uncensor’ ChatGPT

Maxwell Zeff — 8:00 AM PST · February 16, 2025



OpenAI is [changing how it trains AI models](#) to explicitly embrace “intellectual freedom ... no matter how challenging or controversial a topic may be,” the company says in a new policy.

As a result, ChatGPT will eventually be able to answer more questions, offer more perspectives, and reduce the number of topics the AI chatbot won’t talk about.

IMAGE CREDITS:

NATHAN LANE/FLORIAN BLOMBERG / GETTY IMAGES

The changes might be part of OpenAI’s effort to land in the good graces of the new Trump administration, but it also seems to be part of a broader shift in Silicon Valley and what’s considered “AI safety.”

On Wednesday, OpenAI [announced](#) an update to its [Model Spec](#), a 187-page document that lays out how the company trains AI models to behave. In it, OpenAI unveiled a new guiding principle: Do not lie, either by making untrue statements or by omitting important context.

In a new section called “Seek the truth together,” OpenAI says it wants ChatGPT to not take an editorial stance, even if some users find that morally wrong or offensive. That means ChatGPT

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will offer multiple perspectives on controversial subjects, all in an effort to be neutral.

For example, the company says ChatGPT should assert that “Black lives matter,” but also that “all lives matter.” Instead of refusing to answer or picking a side on political issues, OpenAI says it wants ChatGPT to affirm its “love for humanity” generally, then offer context about each movement.

“This principle may be controversial, as it means the assistant may remain neutral on topics some consider morally wrong or offensive,” OpenAI says in the spec. “However, the goal of an AI assistant is to assist humanity, not to shape it.”



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The new Model Spec doesn’t mean that ChatGPT is a total free-for-all now. The chatbot will still refuse to answer certain objectionable questions or respond in a way that supports blatant falsehoods.

These changes could be seen as a response to conservative criticism about ChatGPT’s

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safeguards, which have always seemed to skew center-left. However, an OpenAI spokesperson rejects the idea that it was making changes to appease the Trump administration.

Instead, the company says its embrace of intellectual freedom reflects OpenAI’s “long-held belief in giving users more control.”

But not everyone sees it that way.

Conservatives claim AI censorship



VENTURE CAPITALIST AND TRUMP’S AI “CZAR” DAVID SACKS.

IMAGE CREDITS: STEVE JENNINGS / GETTY IMAGES

Trump’s closest Silicon Valley confidants — including David Sacks, Marc Andreessen, and Elon Musk — have all accused OpenAI of engaging in deliberate AI censorship over the last several months. We wrote in December that [Trump’s crew was setting the stage for AI censorship to be a next culture war issue](#) within Silicon Valley.

Of course, OpenAI doesn’t say it engaged in “censorship,” as Trump’s advisers claim. Rather, the company’s CEO, Sam Altman, previously claimed in a [post on X](#) that ChatGPT’s bias was an unfortunate “shortcoming” that the company was

working to fix, though he noted it would take some time.

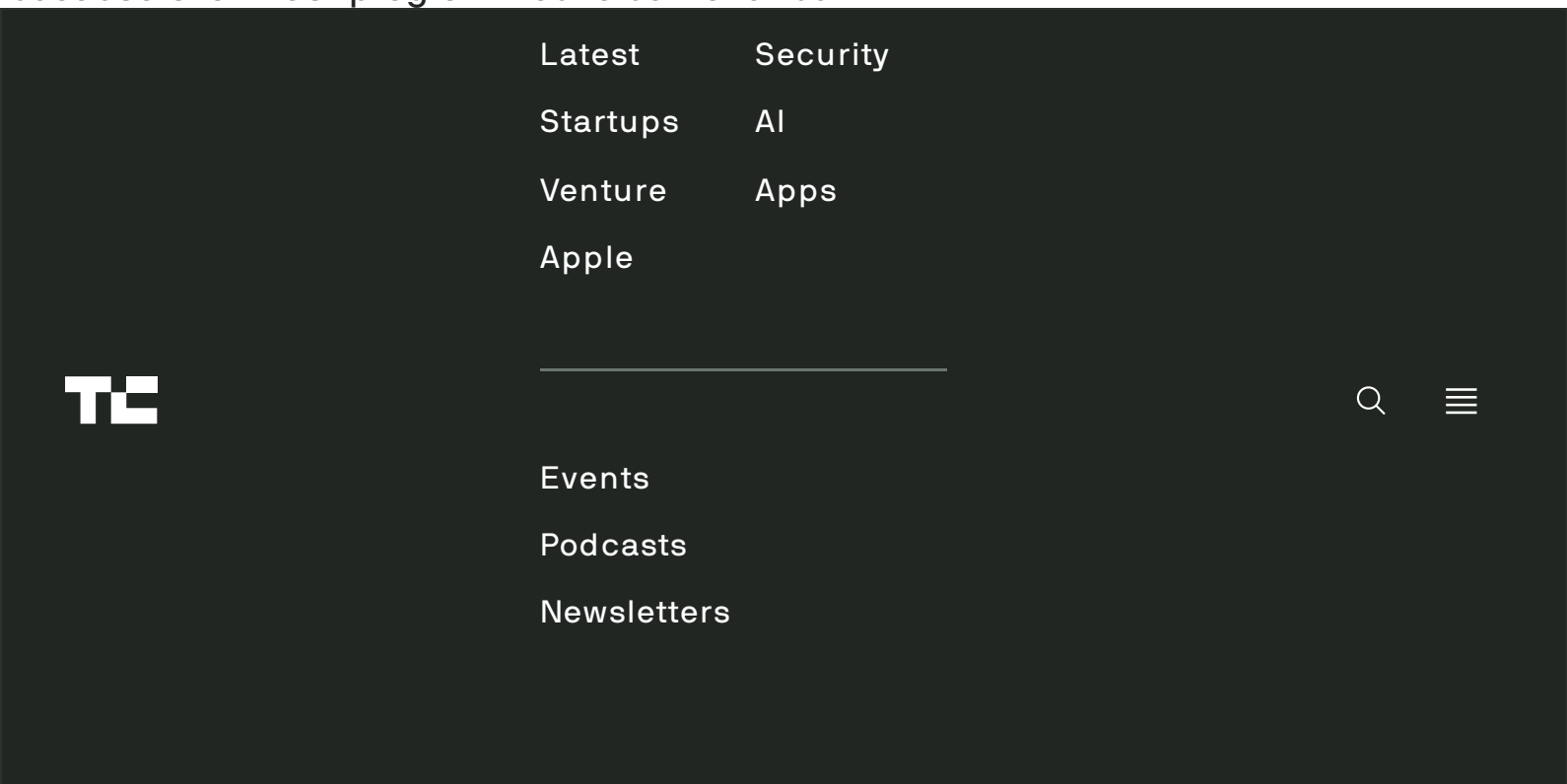
Altman made that comment just after a [viral tweet](#) circulated in which ChatGPT refused to write a poem praising Trump, though it would perform the action for Joe Biden. Many conservatives pointed to this as an example of AI censorship.

The damage done to the credibility of AI by ChatGPT engineers building in political bias is irreparable.
pic.twitter.com/s5fdoa8xQ6

— 🐺 (@LeighWolf) [February 1, 2023](#)

While it's impossible to say whether OpenAI was truly suppressing certain points of view, it's a sheer fact that AI chatbots lean left across the board.

Even Elon Musk admits xAI's chatbot is often more [politically correct](#) than he'd like. It's not because Grok was "programmed to be woke" but



policy update, notes former OpenAI policy leader Miles Brundage in a [post on X](#).

Trump has [previously targeted Silicon Valley companies](#), such as Twitter and Meta, for having

active content moderation teams that tend to shut out conservative voices.

OpenAI may be trying to get out in front of that. But there's also a larger shift going on in Silicon Valley and the AI world about the role of content moderation.

Generating answers to please everyone

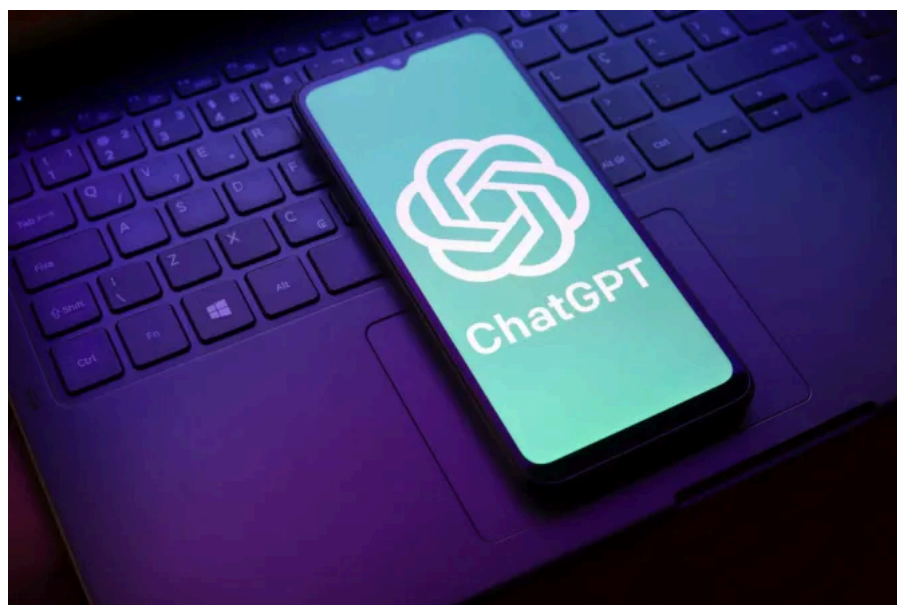


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Newsrooms, social media platforms, and search companies have historically struggled to deliver information to their audiences in a way that feels objective, accurate, and entertaining.

Now, AI chatbot providers are in the same delivery information business, but arguably with the hardest version of this problem yet: How do they automatically generate answers to any question?

Delivering information about controversial, real-time events is a constantly moving target, and it involves taking editorial stances, even if tech companies don't like to admit it. Those stances are bound to upset someone, miss some group's

perspective, or give too much air to some political party.

For example, when OpenAI commits to let ChatGPT represent all perspectives on controversial subjects — including conspiracy theories, racist or antisemitic movements, or geopolitical conflicts — that is inherently an editorial stance.

Some, including OpenAI co-founder John Schulman, argue that it's the right stance for ChatGPT. The alternative — doing a cost-benefit analysis to determine whether an AI chatbot should answer a user's question — could “give the platform too much moral authority,” Schulman notes in a [post on X](#).

Schulman isn't alone. “I think OpenAI is right to push in the direction of more speech,” said Dean Ball, a research fellow at George Mason University's Mercatus Center, in an interview with TechCrunch. “As AI models become smarter and more vital to the way people learn about the world, these decisions just become more important.”

In previous years, AI model providers have tried to stop their AI chatbots from answering questions that might lead to “unsafe” answers. [Almost every AI company stopped their AI chatbot from answering questions about the 2024 election for U.S. president](#). This was widely considered a safe and responsible decision at the time.

But OpenAI's changes to its Model Spec suggest we may be entering a new era for what “AI safety” really means, in which allowing an AI model to answer anything and everything is considered more responsible than making decisions for users.

Ball says this is partially because AI models are just better now. OpenAI has made significant progress on AI model alignment; [its latest reasoning models](#)

[think about the company's AI safety policy before answering](#). This allows AI models to give better answers for delicate questions.

Of course, Elon Musk was the first to implement “free speech” into xAI’s Grok chatbot, perhaps before the company was really ready to handle sensitive questions. It still might be too soon for leading AI models, but now, others are embracing the same idea.

Shifting values for Silicon Valley



GUESTS INCLUDING MARK ZUCKERBERG, LAUREN SANCHEZ, JEFF BEZOS, SUNDAR PICHAI, AND ELON MUSK ATTEND THE INAUGURATION OF DONALD TRUMP.

IMAGE CREDITS: [JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON](#) / GETTY IMAGES

Mark Zuckerberg made waves last month by [reorienting Meta’s businesses around First Amendment principles](#). He praised Elon Musk in the process, saying the owner of X took the right approach by using Community Notes — a community-driven content moderation program — to safeguard free speech.

In practice, both X and Meta ended up dismantling their longstanding trust and safety teams, allowing

more controversial posts on their platforms and amplifying conservative voices.

Changes at X may have hurt its relationships with advertisers, but that could have more to do with [Musk](#), who has taken the [unusual step](#) of suing some of them for boycotting the platform. Early signs indicate that [Meta’s advertisers were unfazed by Zuckerberg’s free speech pivot](#).

Meanwhile, many tech companies beyond X and Meta have walked back from left-leaning policies that dominated Silicon Valley for the last several decades. Google, Amazon, and Intel have [eliminated or scaled back diversity initiatives in the last year](#).

OpenAI may be reversing course, too. The ChatGPT-maker seems to have recently [scrubbed a commitment to diversity, equity, and inclusion](#) from its website.

As OpenAI embarks on [one of the largest American infrastructure projects ever with Stargate](#), a \$500 billion AI datacenter, its relationship with the Trump administration is increasingly important. At the same time, the ChatGPT maker is vying to unseat Google Search as the dominant source of information on the internet.

Coming up with the right answers may prove key to both.

Topics: [AI](#) [ai censorship](#) [ChatGPT](#) [OpenAI](#)





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Republican Congressman Jim Jordan asks Big Tech if Biden tried to censor AI

Maxwell Zeff — 3:12 PM PDT · March 14, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: [JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON](#)

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On Thursday, House Judiciary Chair Jim Jordan (R-OH) [sent letters to 16 American technology firms](#), including Google and OpenAI, asking for past communications with the Biden administration that might suggest the former president “coerced or

colluded” with companies to “censor lawful speech” in AI products.

The Trump administration’s top technology advisors previously signaled they would pick a fight with [Big Tech over “AI censorship,”](#) which is seemingly the next phase in the culture war between conservatives and Silicon Valley. Jordan previously led an investigation into whether the Biden administration and Big Tech [colluded to silence conservative voices on](#) social media platforms. Now, he’s turning his attention to AI companies — and their intermediaries.

In letters to technology executives including Google CEO Sundar Pichai, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, and Apple CEO Tim Cook, Jordan pointed to a [report](#) his committee published in December that he claims “uncovered the Biden-Harris Administration’s efforts to control AI to suppress speech.”

In this latest inquiry, Jordan asked Adobe, Alphabet, Amazon, Anthropic, Apple, Cohere, IBM, Inflection, Meta, Microsoft, Nvidia, OpenAI, Palantir, Salesforce, Scale AI, and Stability AI for information. They have until March 27 to provide it.

TechCrunch reached out to the companies for comment. Most didn’t immediately respond. Nvidia, Microsoft, and Stability AI declined to comment.

There’s one notable omission in Jordan’s list: billionaire Elon Musk’s frontier AI lab, xAI. That may be because Musk, a close Trump ally, is a tech leader who has been [at the forefront of conversations about AI censorship.](#)

The writing was on the wall that conservative lawmakers would ramp up scrutiny over alleged AI censorship. Perhaps in anticipation of an investigation such as Jordan’s, several tech

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companies have changed the ways their AI chatbots handle politically sensitive queries.



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Earlier this year, [OpenAI announced it was changing the way it trains AI models](#) to represent more perspectives and ensure ChatGPT wasn't censoring certain viewpoints. OpenAI denies this was an attempt to appease the Trump administration, but rather an effort to double down on the company's core values.

Anthropic, for its part, has said that its newest AI model, Claude 3.7 Sonnet, will refuse to answer fewer questions and [give more nuanced responses on controversial subjects](#).

Other companies have been slower to change how their AI models treat political subject matter. Leading up to the 2024 U.S. election, Google said that its Gemini chatbot wouldn't respond to political queries. Even well after the election, TechCrunch found that [the chatbot wouldn't consistently](#)

[answer even simple questions related to politics](#),
like “Who is the current President?”

Some tech execs, including Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg, have added fuel to conservative accusations of Silicon Valley censorship by claiming the Biden administration pressured social media companies to [suppress certain content like COVID-19 misinformation](#).

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